Ford Motor Company

October 2001

TO: All Ford and Lincoln Mercury Dealers

SUBJECT: **Owner Notification Program 01B77 Supplement 7:** 10/12/01 Updated Information

REFERENCE: **Owner Notification Program 01B77 – Ford Wilderness AT Program:** Replacement of Wilderness AT tires

PROGRESS TO DATE

- To date we have replaced close to 7 million tires or 55% of the total tires needed
- Ford and Mercury dealers are currently handling over 70% of all Wilderness AT replacements
- All tire sizes are now readily available, though certain brands may not be available

The following information has been updated for ONP 01B77:

CHANGES MADE TO THE ALL DEALER LETTER

- ONP 01B77 – Ford Wilderness AT program will expire on March 31, 2002
- Tires purchased by customers after November 15, 2001 will not be eligible for a refund
- All customers who have not had their tires replaced will receive a follow-up letter by the end of October, 2001 announcing these program changes and encouraging them to visit a Ford Motor Company dealership for tire replacement
- 1995 and 1996 F-150 customers, which were added to the program on August 17, 2001, will receive their first notification letter by the end of October, 2001, which includes the following:
  - The customer must have their tires replaced at a Ford Motor Company dealer
  - They will only be eligible for refunds if they purchased their tires between August 1, 2000 through October 31, 2001

    NOTE: Refunded at actual cost and no DOT sections required, since these customers were never notified of the DOT requirements and maximum dollar limit.
- Effective immediately all tire refund requests are to be processed through the dealer (Online Refund Form should no longer be used)

CHANGES TO ATTACHMENT I

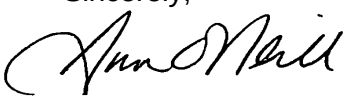
- Tires purchased by customers after November 15, 2001 will not be eligible for a refund
- The Online Refund Form used for refunds before May 22, 2001 is no longer posted on the web

CHANGES TO ATTACHMENT II

- Wait List Survey link added
- A procedure has been added to handle customers who purchase tires after November 15, 2001 and are seeking a refund

All revisions since Supplement 6 are in *red italics* and revised pages have been marked "*Revised10/12/01.*"

Sincerely,



Ann O'Neill
Director
Vehicle Service and Programs

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Ford Motor Company

May 2001
Revised 10/12/01

TO: All Ford and Lincoln Mercury Dealers

SUBJECT: **Owner Notification Program 01B77-S7 – Ford Firestone Wilderness AT Program:** Replacement of Firestone Wilderness AT tires.

OASIS: Yes
OWNER LIST: Yes
PARTS RETURN: No
PROGRAM TERMS: This program will expire *March 31, 2002* and has no mileage limit.

WHAT WE ARE DOING AND WHY

On August 9, 2000 Firestone initiated a voluntary recall of 6.5 million tires, including 3.8 million P235 75R15 Radial ATX tires manufactured since 1990 at all North American Firestone plants. Also, Firestone recalled about 2.7 million P235 75R15 Wilderness AT tires made at its Decatur, Illinois plant. The recall included both original equipment and replacement tires. As of January 22, 2001 more than 6.1 million tires have been replaced – the recall is more than 94% complete.

Under this new owner notification, Ford will replace 13 million Firestone Wilderness AT tires on Ford and Mercury SUVs and pickup trucks listed below under "affected tires and vehicles." This is a voluntary precautionary measure. Ford made the decision to take this action after extensive examination of field data as well as laboratory and track testing in close collaboration with NHTSA. The field data, along with our testing and statistical analysis, shows a directional trend toward elevated failure rates, that differs based upon where the tires were manufactured. Ford does not have sufficient confidence in the future performance of these tires, so we are acting in the interest of our customers to ensure their continued trust and confidence.

To date we have replaced close to 7 million tires or 55% of the total tires needed for this program. Ford and Mercury dealers are currently handling over 70% of the Wilderness AT tire replacements. Also, with the increased availability of all 15-, 16-, and 17-inch tires at the dealers, Ford is changing the expiration date of the program to March 31, 2002 to encourage customers to have their tires replaced as soon as possible.

NOTE: Certain brands of tires may have limited availability.

AFFECTED TIRES AND VEHICLES

This program affects 15-, 16-, and 17-inch Firestone Wilderness AT tires and Ford and Mercury vehicles with these tires on them. The vehicles listed below may have been originally equipped with Firestone Wilderness AT tires or may have had Wilderness AT tires installed during the Firestone recall launched in August, 2000.

- Certain 1991 through 2002 Ford Explorer
- Certain 2001 through 2002 Explorer Sport, and Sport Trac
- Certain 1997 through 2002 Mercury Mountaineer
- Certain 1991 through 2001 Ranger
- Certain 1999 through 2001 Expedition
- Certain 1991 through 1997 F-Series
- Certain 1991 through 1994 Bronco

NOTE: Both original equipment (OE) and replacement tires are affected.

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IMPORTANT FACTS

- *Ford Wilderness AT tire program will expire on March 31, 2002.*
- *Tires purchased by customers after November 15, 2001 will no longer be eligible for a refund.*
- *A follow-up owner letter announcing program changes will be mailed beginning the week of October 17, 2001.*
- *1995 and 1996 F-150 owners, which were added to the program on August 17, 2001, will be notified by the end of October 2001.*
- All 15-, 16-, and 17-inch Firestone Wilderness AT tires (regardless of series number) that are mounted on Ford or Mercury vehicles are eligible for replacement.
- All other Firestone Wilderness AT tire sizes are not included in this program.
- AtW/Ford Tire Program dealers are to stop the sale of Firestone Wilderness AT tires in their parts inventory effective immediately.
- Ford Motor Company has notified customers of this owner notification program via first class mail.
- Customer refunds will be handled differently based on whether the tires were purchased before or after May 22, 2001.
- *Effective immediately all refunds will be processed through the dealer for customers who purchased their tires from August 1, 2000 through November 15, 2001, (Online Refund Form should no longer be used).*
- *1995 and 1996 F-150 owners will only be eligible for refunds for tires purchased between August 1, 2000 and October 31, 2001, (no DOT sections required).*
- A list of Ford-approved replacement tires is posted on QCDealer. Only these tires may be used as replacement tires for vehicles that were originally equipped with 15-, 16-, and 17-inch Firestone Wilderness AT tires under this program.
- There may be cases where a vehicle is equipped with 15-, 16-, or 17-inch Firestone Wilderness AT tire sizes that are not included on the Ford-approved replacement list. These tires are not original equipment (OE) and, therefore, will not have an approved tire listed. In such cases, it is recommended that the customer install the proper OE tire, or have a tire of suitable quality installed. Reference the vehicle's "Safety Certification Label" and current "Ford Motor Company Tire Price Guide" for OE or suitable replacement recommendations.
- **Vehicles with branded titles** - although normally excluded from Owner Notification Programs are included as part of this program.
- Affected vehicles sold in Canada can be serviced by U.S. dealers, and affected vehicles sold in the U.S. can be serviced by Canadian dealers.

STOP SALE OF FIRESTONE WILDERNESS AT TIRES IN DEALER STOCK

Firestone Wilderness AT tires in stock at Ford and Lincoln Mercury dealers enrolled in the Around the Wheel or Ford Tire Program (Certified Tire Dealers) should not be sold. Dealers that purchased these tires through the Ford program and have them in stock should complete the *Unsold Wilderness AT Credit Form* located on QCDealer.com. If you have questions, call the Ford Tire Hotline at 1-888-353-3251 for disposal and credit information.

NON-AtW DEALERS SERVICING IN-STOCK UNITS OR CUSTOMER VEHICLES

Non-Certified Tire (AtW or Ford Tire Program) Dealers who have vehicles in stock, or customer vehicles with 15-, 16-, or 17-inch Firestone Wilderness AT tires must send the vehicle to a Certified Tire Dealer (AtW or Ford Tire Program) or an approved tire retailer participating in the program to have the tire replacement performed. The non-Certified Tire Dealer (AtW or Ford Tire Program) will submit a 01B77 ONP claim using the miscellaneous expense code of "**SCHP**" (with a dollar value of $15.00 to cover administrative costs). Do not claim the "Admin" labor operation.

SERVICE PROCEDURE

All 15-, 16-, and 17-inch Firestone Wilderness AT (regardless of series number) tires installed on Ford and Mercury vehicles must be replaced under this owner notification program. Original equipment (OE) and replacement tires are included.

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Spare Tires

Firestone Wilderness AT (regardless of series number) spare tires are affected and should be replaced. The Firestone P235 75R15 ATX temporary spare tire used on Ranger vehicles is not included in this program.

Note: Spare tires should always be replaced with the exact same size tire; otherwise the spare tire may not store in the proper position on the vehicle.

Note: When processing refunds for customers, inspect the spare tire; if the spare tire is a Firestone Wilderness AT (with the Ranger exception noted previously) replace the spare tire using the information provided on Attachment II.

Does Current Tire Condition Affect Replacement Procedure?

All affected tires should be replaced regardless of the mileage or the remaining tread on the tire. If the customer caused damage to the tires, i.e. hit a curb, accident, under inflation, alignment issues, the tire should still be replaced. If the tire is worn out, it should still be replaced.

What if the Vehicle has a Mix of Affected and Non-Affected Tires?

- If the spare tire is the only Wilderness AT, then only the spare should be replaced (see exception on temporary spares above).
- In most cases an owner's vehicle will have all 15-, 16-, or 17–inch Firestone Wilderness AT tires installed and require replacement of all tires. In cases where a vehicle has a mix of tire brands/sizes installed, replace all Firestone Wilderness AT tires and the remaining tires to match the tire brand and size by axle.

For example, if a vehicle has a Wilderness AT on the left front, a Wilderness AT on the right rear, a Wilderness AT for a spare, and the other two tires are not Wilderness AT; the spare and the left front and right rear should be replaced and the new tires should be installed on the same axle. The customer should also be advised that all tires should be the same size especially on 4 X 4 models.

What replacement tires may be used for vehicles originally equipped with 15-, 16-, or 17-inch Firestone Wilderness AT tires?

Replacement tire(s) must be on the list of tires approved by Ford <link to approved tire list>. Any deviation from this approved list may change the vehicles handling, ride, vibration, and noise characteristics and cannot be claimed through Ford.

If customers are seeking reimbursement for tires purchased outside of a Ford Certified Tire Dealer, refer to Attachment I for reimbursement guidelines and claiming procedures. *Customers who purchase tires after November 15, 2001 are not eligible for a refund.*

Note: There may be cases where a vehicle is equipped with 15-, 16-, or 17-inch Firestone Wilderness AT tire sizes that are not included on the Ford-approved replacement list. These tires are not original equipment (OE) and, therefore, will not have an approved tire listed. In such cases, it is recommended that the customer install the proper OE tire, or have a tire of suitable quality installed. Reference the vehicle's "Safety Certification Label" and current "Ford Motor Company Tire Price Guide" for OE or suitable replacement recommendations.

Note: "Blemished" tires may not be used as replacement tires under this program.

FORD AND LINCOLN MERCURY DEALER TIRE DISPOSAL PROCESS

- Tires that are removed from vehicles must immediately be made unusable by either cutting the bead through the DOT code with bolt cutters, or drilling a one-inch diameter hole (directly on the DOT code to make the code unreadable) in the sidewall. Defacing the DOT code will prevent the tire from being used for an additional refund request. Marking the last 6 characters of the VIN on the removed tire(s) is no longer required.
- The tires will be disposed of by using the "National Tire Recovery and Recycle Program".

Regional FCSD and independent personnel will be randomly auditing dealers for proper tire scrapping and claiming procedures. Any infractions will result in prior approval for tire owner notification claims.

Note: Make removed tires unusable during tire replacement. Do not stack tires and disable them at a later time.

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DEALERSHIPS ELIGIBLE TO REPLACE TIRES UNDER THIS PROGRAM

All Ford and Lincoln Mercury dealers enrolled on the Around the Wheel or Ford Tire Program (Certified Tire Dealers) are eligible to complete tire replacements under this program.

Ford dealers interested in joining the Ford Tire Program may call the Ford Tire Hotline 1-888-353-3251 for enrollment and program details.

APPROVED RETAILERS PARTICIPATION IN PROGRAM

We have developed a program to authorize Goodyear, Michelin, Continental, and General tire retailers to perform tire replacements at no cost to customers. These eligible retailers will use only tires from the Ford Approved Tire List when performing no cost replacements. This was done to reduce customer inconvenience by:

- Eliminating customer out of pocket expense
- Maximize the number of customers whose replacement tires are those on the Ford Approved tire list
- Expedite the completion of this program
- Reduce administrative burden on our Ford and Lincoln Mercury dealers
- Reduce dealer tire disposal responsibility
- Allow dealers to continue with their normal day to day service business

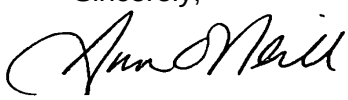
ATTACHMENTS

Attachment I: Administrative Information
Attachment II: Labor Allowances and Parts Ordering Information
Attachment III: Technical Information

CONTACTS

Claims Information: 1-800-423-8851
For Around the Wheel/Ford Tire Program Questions: 1-888-353-3251
Ford Tire Inquiry Hotline (Customer): 1-866-300-1226
Other (Dealer Only) Program Questions: 1-800-325-5621
Tire Registration for Federal Regulations Questions: 1-330-794-9190

Sincerely,



Ann O'Neill
Director
Vehicle Service and Programs

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01B77-S7 Tire Owner Notification Program
Replacement of Firestone Wilderness AT Tires

OASIS

OASIS must be used to determine vehicle eligibility.

IMPORTANT: When an eligible vehicle is at the dealership for service, OASIS must be contacted to determine if Owner Notification Program 01B77 is open. If 01B77 is listed in OASIS as open, it is important that the vehicle is inspected for eligible tires. If the eligible vehicle is not equipped with 15-, 16-, or 17-inch Firestone Wilderness AT tires a claim must be submitted using labor operation 01B77A to close the program. If an affected vehicle does not have 01B77 open, this may indicate that a refund or tire replacement has already been processed on this vehicle.

Some Ford and Lincoln Mercury vehicles not listed in the AFFECTED TIRES AND VEHICLES list may have 15-, 16-, or 17-inch Firestone Wilderness AT tires installed. These vehicles are covered under this program, but will not be active in OASIS. Contact the Special Service Support Center at 1-800-325-5621 to obtain prior approval before performing the repair or issuing a refund. This will insure that a previous repair/refund has not been performed on the vehicle.

CLAIMS PREPARATION AND SUBMISSION

- Enter claims using DWE.
- Refer to ACESII User Manual for claims preparation and submission information.
- Enter information on a **Recall/ONP** claim type. DO NOT use a Warranty Claim type.
- Program code 01B77.
- Enter the full part number of the replacement tire with the quantity of tires replaced. Tires will be reimbursed at AtW Dealer cost + 25% (wheel weights and valve stems incl.).
- Use the appropriate labor operation(s) from Attachment II.
- Freight is reimbursable at actual cost in the miscellaneous expense area of the claim.
  NOTE: Freight is only reimbursable for rural dealers whose only means of acquiring tires is by having them shipped in via common carrier. Dealers are encouraged to arrange for shipment of 4 or more tires at a time.
- Dealers can no longer claim tire disposal for ONP 01B77. See the "National Tire Recovery and Recycle Program". You may still claim any applicable local waste tax – enter OTHER in the expense area of the claim with the actual cost.
- **Enter each unique (complete 10 or 11 digit) DOT codes** of the replaced tires **on the diagnostic code entry screen in the field marked "other".** If the DOT codes cannot be completely entered in the space provided in the diagnostic code area, use the technician comment area to complete the data entry.

RELATED DAMAGE

Vehicle damage caused by a tire related failure is not covered by this program. Refer to the Warranty and Policy Manual for proper claiming procedure for vehicles covered by the Ford Bumper-to-Bumper Tire Warranty (model years 2001 and 2002). All other pre-2001 model year vehicles with alleged tire related vehicle damage should be handled through the Firestone claims process, or by referring the customers to their insurance company.

Damage related to replacement of tires should be handled as described in the Warranty and Policy Manual.

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01B77-S7 Tire Owner Notification Program
Replacement of Firestone Wilderness AT Tires

OWNER REFUND

With the increased availability of replacement tires, it will no longer be necessary for customers to pay out-of-pocket expenses for tires. Therefore, refund requests for tires purchased after November 15, 2001 will no longer be granted. Owners will be notified of the refund expiration date and will be directed to a Ford or Mercury dealer. They are directed to an authorized retailer only if the Ford or Mercury dealer cannot meet their scheduling needs or tires are not in stock. All Ford and Mercury dealers (AtW and non-AtW dealers) are required to process refunds for customers who purchase tires prior to November 15, 2001.

The following rules apply to refunds for tires purchased from August 1, 2000 through November 15, 2001:

- Refunds will be processed for vehicles listed under "AFFECTED TIRES AND VEHICLES", and for other Ford and Lincoln Mercury vehicles that have 15-, 16-, or 17-inch Wilderness AT tires installed.
- The customer must provide the original paid receipt (a copy of their paid receipt is acceptable on an exception basis in instances where the owner requires the original for another purpose (e.g. extended tire warranty or purchase rebate). The dealer will attach the receipt to the dealer file copy of the refund claim (see claim instructions below).
- Dealers will be reimbursed to immediately disable tires returned for a refund (see claiming instructions for refunds and Attachment II for labor operations).
- *The tires must be purchased August 1, 2000 through November 15, 2001 to be eligible for a refund (through October 31, 2001 for 1995 and 1996 F-150 owners).*
- Customers requesting refunds for tire replacement May 22, 2001 through November 15, 2001 must provide either:

NOTE: This does not apply to 1995 and 1996 F-150 customers.

- The Firestone Wilderness AT tires that were replaced. Returned tire(s) are to be disabled by the dealership. Ford will reimburse the dealer to disable (see claim instructions below and use labor operation 01B77G). **If tires are brought in for refund with the DOT codes missing dealers should not process the refund.**
- A section of the old tire(s) containing the DOT codes from each of the Firestone Wilderness AT tires that were replaced **(To be cut from the Wilderness AT tires that were replaced by the outside repair facility)**(use labor operation 01B77L)**.** Dealers should deface (cut in pieces or make code unreadable) the DOT sections of the tire so they cannot be used to obtain another refund. If sections are brought in for refund with the DOT code defaced dealers should not process the refund.

NOTE: The DOT Code Identification Guide has been developed to help dealers determine if the DOT sections returned to the dealership are from 15-, 16-, or 17-inch Firestone Wilderness AT tires. Use the DOT Code Identification Guide in conjunction with the bulletin section " **What if the Vehicle has a Mix of Affected and Non-Affected Tires**" to determine how many tires are eligible for refund.

NOTE: Ford will allow customers to file for a refund (with or without tires) for tires purchased after May 22 through June 30, 2001 because customers may not have tires to turn in. Customers must provide a paid receipt indicating tire replacement before July 1, 2001in order to process a refund without tires or DOT sections. Customers who purchase tires after June 30, 2001 must provide tires or DOT sections.

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01B77-S7 Tire Owner Notification Program
Replacement of Firestone Wilderness AT Tires

Ford will reimburse customers the following amounts:

- Tires purchased from August 1, 2000 through May 22, 2001, the actual cost as stated on their paid receipt for replacing tires, mounting, balancing, valve stems, disposal, and taxes.
- ***(1995 and 1996 F-150 vehicle only)*** *Tires purchased from August 1, 2000 through October 31, 2001, the actual cost as stated on their paid receipt for replacing tires, mounting, balancing, valve stems, disposal, and taxes. No DOT section required.*
- *Tires purchased May 23, 2001 through November 15, 2001*, the actual cost as stated on the receipt for replacing tires, mounting, balancing, valve stems, disposal, and taxes up to a **maximum of $110 per tire for 15 inch, and $130 per tire for 16 and 17 inch tires**.
- *Refunds will not be granted for tires purchased after November 15, 2001.*

Note: If an owner pays for the replacement of their tires after November 15, 2001, the dealer may handle on a case-by-case basis following the procedure in Attachment II.

Purchase Date Range	Refund Guidelines
August 1, 2000 through May 22, 2001	• The actual cost as stated on the paid receipt for replacing tires, mounting, balancing, valve stems, disposal, and taxes • *Effective immediately dealers process refunds (Online Refund Form should no longer be used)*
1995 and 1996 F-150 vehicles only *August 1, 2000 through October 31, 2001*	• *The actual cost as stated on the paid receipt for replacing tires, mounting, balancing, valve stems, disposal, and taxes (no DOT required)* • *Effective immediately dealers process refunds (Online Refund Form should no longer be used)*
May 23, 2001 through November 15, 2001	• 15 inch tires - $110 (includes mounting, balancing, stems, disposal, and taxes) • 16 and 17 inch tires - $130 (includes mounting, balancing, stems, disposal, and taxes) • Dealers process refunds
After November 15, 2001	• *No refunds accepted for tires purchased after November 15, 2001*

Refund Questions	**What is the owner qualified to receive?**
Example: On December 21, 2000 the customer paid to have (4) Firestone Wilderness AT tires replaced on an affected vehicle.	o August 1, 2000 through May 22, 2001 (October 31, 2001 for 1995 and 1996 F-150)– full refund with paid receipt o Customer does not need old tire(s) o *Effective immediately dealers process refunds (Online Refund Form should no longer be used)*
Example: On January 15, 2001 the customer paid to have (2) Wilderness AT tires replaced on a 1988 F-Series truck. The other tires are non-Firestone Wilderness AT.	o August 1, 2000 through May 22, 2001 – full refund with paid receipt o Dealer contacts Special Service Support Center at 1-800-325-5621 for approval code o Customer does not need old tire(s) o *Effective immediately dealers process refunds (Online Refund Form should no longer be used)*

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Refund Questions	What is the owner qualified to receive?
Example: On May 27, 2001 the customer took their 1998 Explorer to an outside tire retailer and had (5) Firestone Wilderness AT 16 inch tires replaced.	o After May 22, 2001 refund tire replacement with paid receipt up to: o 15 inch = $110 (maximum per tire) o 16 and 17 inch = $130 (maximum per tire) o With a paid receipt this customer would be entitled to (5) tires x $130 (16 inch maximum per tire) = $650 refund (includes mounting, balancing, stems, disposal, and taxes) o Dealer will be eligible to claim for refund allowance using labor operation 01B77L o If the customer returns the old tires to the dealer o The dealer will disable the old tires and dispose of them using the *"National Tire Recovery and Recycle Program"* using labor operation 01B77G (disable) in conjunction with 01B77L (refund allowance) o Customer does not need old tire(s) *since tires purchased prior to July 1, 2001* (After June 30, 2001 customer will need old tires or removed DOT codes from replaced tires to qualify)
Example: On December 2, 2000 the owner replaced their (5) Firestone Wilderness AT tires with another set of Wilderness AT tires.	o The owner is not eligible for refund o The owner is eligible for tire replacement only o Use only tires from the "Ford Approved Tire List"
Example: *On November 16, 2001 the owner purchases tires from a tire retailer.*	o *No refund will be granted after November 15, 2001* o *Dealers may handle on a case-by-case (See Attachment II)*
Example: *On October 10, 2001 a 1995 F-150 owner purchases tires from a tire retailer.*	o *August 1, 2000 through October 31, 2001 – full refund with paid receipt* o *Customer does not need old tire(s) or DOT section(s)* o *Effective immediately dealers process refunds (Online Refund Form should no longer be used)*

CLAIMS PREPARATION FOR REFUNDS *(USE THIS PROCEDURE FOR ALL REFUND REQUESTS)*

NOTE: Tires must be purchased prior to November 15, 2001

- Enter claims using DWE.
- Refer to ACESII User Manual for claims preparation and submission information.
- Enter information on a **Recall/ONP** claim type. DO NOT use a Warranty Claim type.
- Program code 01B77.
- When a customer brings in their old tires and is seeking a refund, use labor operation **01B77G (disable)** and **01B77L (refund administration allowance)** from Attachment II.
- If a customer brings in the old DOT codes removed from the old tires - use labor operation **01B77L** only.
- The Miscellaneous Expense Code "ADMIN" will not be accepted under this program. A labor operation 01B77L has been provided to cover administrative costs.
- Enter REFUND in the miscellaneous area of the claim.
- Dealers will no longer be able to claim tire disposal for ONP 01B77. See the "National Tire Recovery and Recycle Program". You may still claim any applicable local waste tax – enter OTHER in the expense area of the claim with the actual cost.
- **Enter each unique (complete 10 or 11 digit) DOT codes of the replaced tires in the diagnostic code entry screen in the field marked "other".** If the DOT codes cannot be completely entered in the space provided in the diagnostic code area, use the technician comment area to complete the data entry. **If the tires were replaced prior to May 23, 2001 *(or November 1, 2001 for 1995 and 1996 F-150* customers) the DOT may not be available, in this case record the brand, make and size of the tires** in the technician comments area of the claim.

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01B77-S7 Tire Owner Notification Program
Replacement of Firestone Wilderness AT Tires

RENTAL CARS

TAP allowances have been increased specifically for this owner notification program. Refer to Don Brunner letter.

DOT REGISTRATION OF NEW TIRES

Dealers are required to register the DOT number of every tire sold to meet federal tire registration requirements. Ford has established a partnership with CIMS to assist dealers in registering these DOT codes. Information is available on QCDealer.com under CIMS Tire Registration or by contacting CIMS at 330-794-9190.

NON-FORD OR LINCOLN MERCURY VEHICLES WITH FIRESTONE WILDERNESS AT

Non-Ford or Lincoln Mercury vehicles with 15-, 16-, or 17-inch Firestone Wilderness AT tires **installed by a Certified Tire Dealer (AtW or Ford Tire Program)** are eligible for replacement. The repair should be submitted using a Warranty/ESP claim type form. The dealer **must** enter Program Code "**P19**", this will allow the repair to be submitted without a VIN. The causal part must be **TIRE**, with the actual part numbers for reimbursement at dealer cost plus 25%, and use actual time for labor reimbursement. These types of claims **cannot** be submitted as an Owner Notification Repair type.

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01B77-S7 Tire Owner Notification Program
Replacement of Firestone Wilderness AT Tires

LABOR ALLOWANCES

Description	Labor Operation	Labor Time
Inspect for non-Wilderness AT tires (used to close 01B77 not for use when processing a refund)	01B77A	0.2 Hours
Replace & balance 1 tire (to be used for spare tire only)	01B77B	0.4 Hours
Replace & balance 2 tires (one axle)	01B77C	0.6 Hours
Replace & balance 3 tires (one axle plus spare)	01B77D	0.8 Hours
Replace & balance 4 tires (both axles)	01B77E	1.0 Hours
Replace & balance 5 tires	01B77F	1.2 Hours
Disable up to five tires (used only for refund claims)	01B77G	0.2 Hours
*Refund administration allowance (to be used when processing a customer refund without tire disposal, if tires are returned to dealership for disposal use in conjunction with operation 01B77G)	01B77L	0.2 Hours
Administrative Allowance for Non-Certified Tire Dealers (AtW or Ford Tire Program) to be used when sending a dealer stock unit, or customer vehicle (for tire replacement) to a Certified Tire Dealer, or tire retailer authorized to perform tire replacement under this program	Misc. Expense use code "SCHP"	$15.00

NOTE: Front-end alignment is not included in this program.

***NOTE:** When processing a refund for four (4) road tires, the non-temporary spare tire should be replaced as part of this program – file a related damage claim to cover the spare tire replacement.

NON-AtW DEALERS SERVICING IN-STOCK UNITS OR CUSTOMER VEHICLES

NOTE: Non-Certified Tire Dealers (AtW or Ford Tire Program) who have vehicles in stock, or customer vehicles with 15-, 16-, or 17-inch Firestone Wilderness AT tires must send the vehicle to a Certified Tire Dealer (AtW or Ford Tire Program), or an approved tire retailer participating in the program to have the tire replacement performed. The non-Certified Tire Dealer (AtW or Ford Tire Program) will submit a 01B77 ONP claim using the miscellaneous expense code of "**SCHP**" (with a dollar value of $15.00 to cover administrative costs). Do not claim the "Admin" labor operation.

PARTS REQUIREMENTS

Tire Ordering Information

- Dealers are required to install only tires from the Approved Tire List for vehicles originally equipped with 15-, 16-, and 17-inch Firestone Wilderness AT tires. Dealers should immediately order replacement tires for inventory.
- Certified Tire Dealers will order replacement tires through normal channels.
- Dealers not authorized for the Around the Wheel Program will not participate in this recall. Dealers may call the Ford Tire Hotline 1-888-353-3251 for enrollment and program details.

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01B77-S7 Tire Owner Notification Program
Replacement of Firestone Wilderness AT Tires

TIRE AVAILABILITY:

All dealers should check QCDealer.com daily for updates to the approved tires list. Distributors and tire retailers will allocate tires as best they can on a daily basis. Your dealership should do the following to ensure that you are able to secure your fair allotment of these limited volumes:

- Contact your Ford authorized facing distributor(s) for each tire manufacturer.
- Contact your Ford authorized facing tire retailers for each tire manufacturer.
- Review with these supply points the volume of tires you need to ensure you have tires ready to fill orders with every supply point.

Questions not addressed by above sources should be directed to your market area team.

CUSTOMER WAIT LISTS:

Dealers should create a customer wait list and record: Customer name

- Address and phone number
- Vehicle make
- Model year
- Mileage
- Tire size

NOTE: Customers should be prioritized to replace oldest tires first.

WAIT LIST SURVEY

Please fill out the Firestone Tire Survey in the Management Report Section of QCDealer weekly. It is critical that you answer the questions as accurately as possible as the survey results will be used to help determine the level of production from the tire manufacturers.

DEALER PRICE

For latest prices on replacement tires, refer to the most recent Ford Motor Company Tire Price List.

PROCEDURE FOR CLAIMING REFUNDS FOR TIRES PURCHASED AFTER NOVEMBER 15, 2001

The following procedure applies to tires purchased after November 15, 2001:

1. *Determine if the customer should receive special consideration based on owner loyalty, special circumstance, etc.*
2. *If the customer is eligible for special consideration the dealer will call the Special Service Support Center at 1-800-325-5621 to request an authorization code*
3. *The Special Service Support Center representative will ask for the following:*
   - *Customer Name*
   - *VIN*
   - *Date of repair*
   - *Original copy of Invoice (be prepared to fax)*
4. *If the customer qualifies for a refund, the Special Service Support Center will provide your dealer with an authorization code*
5. *Your dealer will input a claim with the authorization code* ***(authorization code must be included to receive payment)***
6. *After the dealer receives payment for the claim, the dealer will then send the refund to the customer*

NOTE: If the Special Service Support Center determines that the customer does not qualify for a refund, no authorization code will be given. Any appeals must be made by the dealer to the appropriate field representative.

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01B77-S7 Tire Owner Notification Program
Replacement of Firestone Wilderness AT Tires

AFFECTED VEHICLES: REFER TO DEALER LETTER FOR AFFECTED TIRES AND VEHICLES

OVERVIEW

This program details the replacement of 15-, 16-, and 17-inch Firestone Wilderness AT tires regardless of production plant. You will need to perform a DOT code inspection prior to replacing the 15, 16, or 17-inch Wilderness AT tires.

NOTE: When lowering or raising an under-vehicle spare, **DO NOT** use power tools. Also make sure that the spare is secure under the vehicle, and not swinging loose. The spare tire winch will ratchet when the tire is completely stowed.

NOTE: Radial ATX "TEMPORARY USE" spare tires are not included under this program, and should not be replaced as part of this program.

NOTE: Spare tires should always be replaced with the exact same size tire; otherwise the spare tire may not store in the proper position on the vehicle.

INSPECTION

1. Inspect the vehicle tires (including the spare tire) for the presence of Firestone Wilderness AT tires.
2. If Firestone Wilderness AT tires are present replace them with a suitable replacement from the "Approved Tire List".
   Note: There may be cases where a vehicle is equipped with 15-, 16-, or 17-inch Firestone Wilderness AT tire sizes that are not included on the Ford-approved replacement list. These tires are not original equipment (OE) and, therefore, will not have an approved tire listed. In such cases, it is recommended that the customer install the proper OE tire, or have a tire of suitable quality installed. Reference the vehicle's "Safety Certification Label" and current "Ford Motor Company Tire Price Guide" for OE or suitable replacement recommendations.
3. If only one Firestone Wilderness AT road tire is present on the vehicle, you will need to replace the opposing tire on the same axle. However, if one (1) front and one (1) rear tire are Wilderness AT you would not automatically replace all four (4) tires instead, you would replace the two (2) Wilderness AT tires and place them on the same axle.
4. **Record the DOT code from each removed tire(s) on the repair order.**
5. Tires that are removed from vehicles must immediately be made unusable by either cutting through the bead and DOT code with bolt cutters, or drilling a one-inch diameter hole (directly on the DOT code to make the code unreadable) in the sidewall.
6. Adjust all tires to the proper inflation pressure, and release the vehicle. For specifications, refer to the vehicle Owner's Manual or the vehicle certification label located on the driver's door opening.

NOTE: Tires that are removed from vehicles under this program, and those in dealer inventory must immediately be made unusable by either cutting the bead with bolt cutters or drilling a 1" diameter hole (directly on the DOT code to make the code unreadable) in the sidewall. Defacing the DOT code will prevent the tire from being used for an additional refund request.

NOTE: If the vehicle is a 4X4, and is equipped with non-Firestone Wilderness AT tires on one axle, and the replacement tires for the Firestone equipped axle causes a mismatch with the existing non-Firestone axle, the customer is responsible for the tire mismatch. If the customer refuses to purchase matching tires to correct the mismatch - the dealer should annotate the repair order to reflect the customer's decision.

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